

Tennessee Comprehensive Assessment Program

TCAP

Social Studies
Grade 8
Practice Items



The text by William Bradford describes Squanto.

He told them also of another Indian whose name was Squanto, a native of this place who had been in England and could speak better English than himself. . . . Squanto continued with them and was their interpreter and was a special instrument . . . good beyond their expectation. He directed them how to set their corn, where to take fish, and to procure [get] other commodities [supplies], and was also their pilot to bring them to unknown places for their profit, and never left them till he died.

— William Bradford, *The Pilgrims Arrive in Plymouth*

According to this excerpt, Squanto was important to the Pilgrims because he

- A.** understood the language and helped the Pilgrims to survive.
- B.** taught the Pilgrims how to resist certain diseases.
- C.** had lived in England and knew about Pilgrim traditions.
- D.** made peace between the Pilgrims and French traders.

The list describes a historical figure.

Roger Williams

- Argued to break from the Church of England
- Strong advocate for religious toleration
- Banished from the Massachusetts Bay Colony

Which phrase could be added to this list?

- A.** Converted beliefs of many American Indians
- B.** Founded a colony for Quaker settlers
- C.** Established the colony of Rhode Island
- D.** Escaped from captivity in Plymouth

Which action resulted in New Netherland being renamed New York?

- A.** The Dutch left the area in exchange for the release of captives held by American Indians.
- B.** The Dutch renamed the area after the Duke of York bought the land in exchange for gold.
- C.** The English landed with many troops and offered the Dutch fair treatment if they would surrender.
- D.** The American Indians ended all trade with the Dutch merchants and forced them to leave the area.

The map displays a region of North America.

13 Colonies



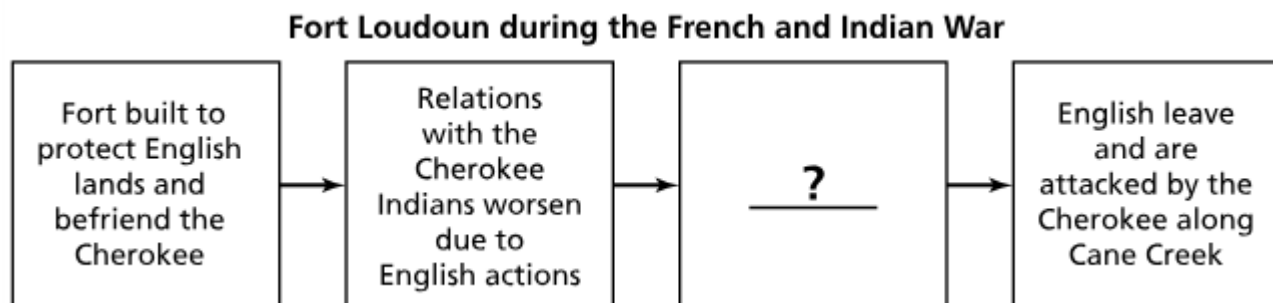
Which numbers on the map identify Connecticut and Virginia?

- A.** 1 and 6
- B.** 2 and 5
- C.** 3 and 4
- D.** 1 and 3

During the colonial period, Great Britain used the American colonies **primarily** as a source of

- A.** finished goods.
- B.** raw materials.
- C.** industrial equipment.
- D.** slaves.

The diagram describes an event during the French and Indian War.



Which event **best** completes this diagram?

- A. Cherokee agree to peace talks to leave the fort alone
- B. French soldiers in the fort train the Cherokee to use muskets
- C. Cherokee lay siege to the fort and the English surrender
- D. French join the Cherokee and begin to attack the fort

The political cartoon was created by Benjamin Franklin in 1754.

**Political Cartoon Created by
Benjamin Franklin, 1754**

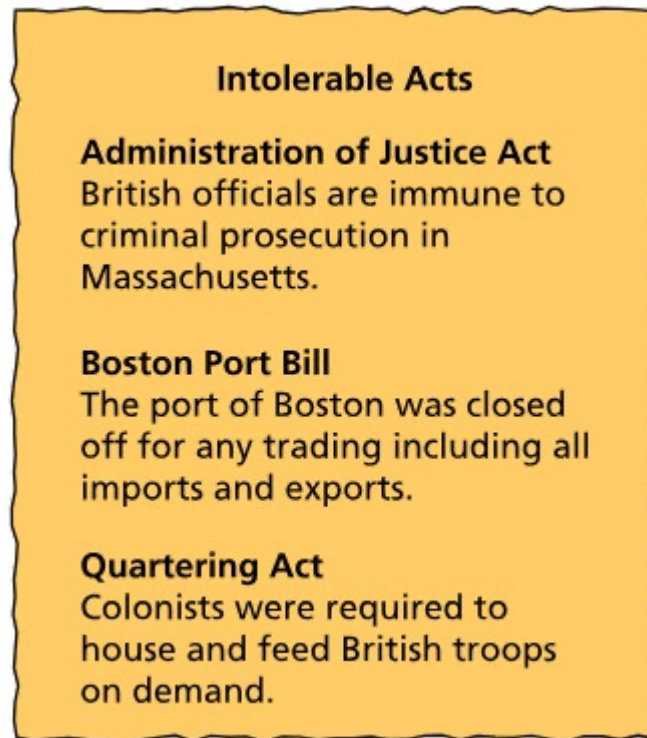


Source: Library of Congress

What was the purpose of this political cartoon?

- A.** to encourage colonies to band together in defense against the French
- B.** to inspire citizens from different colonies to join the Continental Army
- C.** to motivate the French to support the colonists in a war against Britain
- D.** to show that the colonists were ready to fight with the American Indians

The list provides information about a historical event.



How did these acts contribute to the start of the American Revolution?

- A.** They forced colonists to establish a barter system for needed goods.
- B.** They prevented the colonies from freely trading with foreign markets.
- C.** They created anger among the colonists toward the English actions.
- D.** They restricted colonists from producing agricultural goods.

Which **two** reasons explain the failure of the State of Franklin?

- A.** The settlers could not agree on a written constitution.
- B.** The establishment of the state was opposed by North Carolina.
- C.** The state tried to include the settlements on the Cumberland River.
- D.** The state did not receive approval from the national government.
- E.** The settlers chose a governor with no military or political experience.

The excerpt is from the United States Constitution.

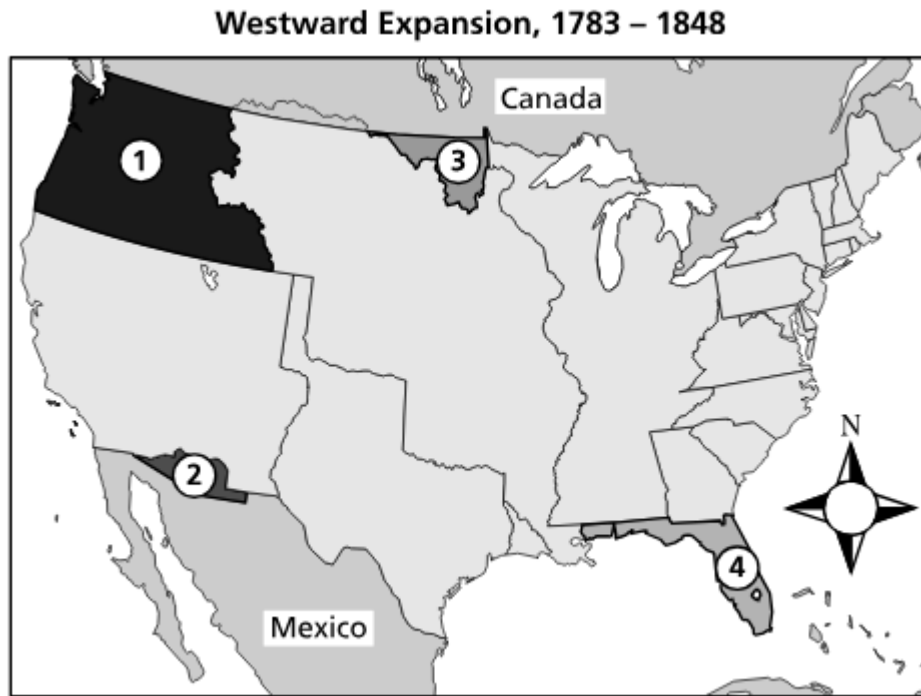
The Congress, whenever two thirds of both houses shall deem it necessary, shall propose amendments to this Constitution . . . which . . . shall be valid to all intents and purposes, as part of this Constitution, when ratified by the legislatures of three fourths of the several states.

— Article 5, United States Constitution

Which principle of government is **most** evident in this source?

- A. popular sovereignty
- B. judicial review
- C. individual rights
- D. federalism

The map shows the United States in 1783-1848.



As a result of the Adams-Onís Treaty, the boundaries of the United States expanded to include which numbered area?

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3
- D. 4

The text describes the Southern United States in the 1800s.

The fertile soil and warm climate of the South made it ideal for large-scale farms and crops like tobacco and cotton. . . . Eighty percent of the labor force worked on the farm. Although two-thirds of Southerners owned no slaves at all, by 1860 the South's "peculiar institution" was inextricably tied to the region's economy and culture. . . . Only one-tenth of Southerners lived in urban areas and transportation between cities was difficult, except by water. Only 35% of the nation's train tracks were located in the South. Also, in 1860, the South's agricultural economy was beginning to stall while the Northern manufacturers were experiencing a boom.

— Civil War Trust

Based on the source, which statement **best** analyzes conditions in the South prior to the Civil War?

- A.** Southern governments invested large amounts of capital into new infrastructure projects.
- B.** The South relied heavily on agricultural production and had experienced little industrial development.
- C.** Southern governments encouraged immigration to fill growing demand for labor in new factories.
- D.** The South relied heavily on the use of skilled labor and had grown increasingly dependent on foreign trade.

What was one innovation developed by Eli Whitney?

- A.** the use of interchangeable parts
- B.** the development of the assembly line
- C.** the emergence of trade unions
- D.** the development of textile factories

Which reason caused massive Irish immigration into the United States during the mid-19th century?

- A.** a major famine in Ireland
- B.** a violent revolution in Ireland
- C.** a desire to work in highly skilled jobs
- D.** a desire to have greater religious freedoms

The source is the Declaration of Sentiments, written by Elizabeth Cady Stanton.

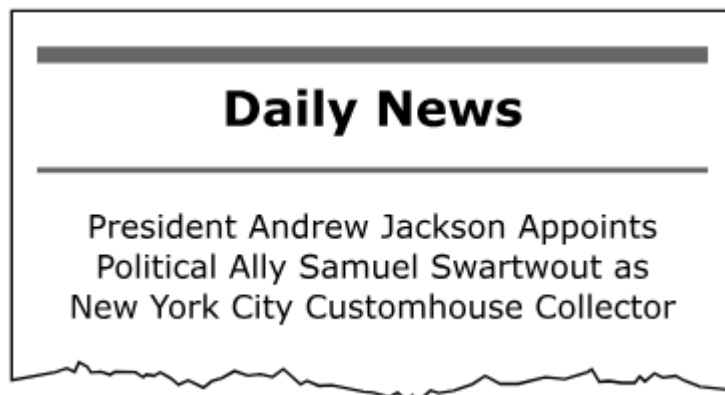
We hold these truths to be self-evident; that all men and women are created equal. . . . He has never permitted her to exercise her inalienable right to the elective franchise. He has compelled her to submit to laws, in the formation of which she had no voice.

— Declaration of Sentiments, 1848

Based on the excerpt, how did Elizabeth Cady Stanton attempt to persuade audiences to support her cause for women?

- A.** by comparing the situation to that of the colonists under Great Britain
- B.** by describing the superiority of the United States government to that of other governments
- C.** by arguing that groups underrepresented should fight for their rights together
- D.** by explaining that state governments had the duty and responsibility to protect citizens

The headline describes a historical event.



What activity is described in this newspaper headline?

- A.** creation of a new political party
- B.** passage of a trade treaty
- C.** use of the spoils system
- D.** use of the presidential veto

The photograph shows a historic location.

The Alamo, San Antonio, Texas



Source: Library of Congress

Which statement accurately describes the connection between David Crockett and this historic landmark?

- A.** He led Texas troops in a successful surprise attack on Mexican forces.
- B.** He was the surviving officer who accepted the surrender of the Mexican forces.
- C.** He rallied the troops to continue defending the Alamo despite overwhelming odds.
- D.** He brought a large force of Texas volunteers to help defend the Alamo after the battle had begun.

The map shows a trail across the United States.



This trail was **mainly** used by settlers seeking

- A. fertile land for crops.
- B. freedom of religious beliefs.
- C. profits from silver mines.
- D. grassy lands for raising cattle.

Why was John Sutter important to the future of California?

- A.** Sutter built schools to educate incoming immigrant children.
- B.** Sutter's lands were the location where gold was first discovered.
- C.** Sutter built a railroad across his land to sell beef to eastern cities.
- D.** Sutter's stories inspired people to visit the territory.

What was the significance of the Gadsden Purchase?

- A.** It doubled the size of the country.
- B.** It gave the United States access to Central American ports.
- C.** It established a balance between slave states and free states.
- D.** It allowed for the creation of a southern railroad across the United States.

The text is from President Abraham Lincoln's First Inaugural Address.

It is found in nearly all the published speeches of him who now addresses you. I do but quote from one of those speeches when I declare that — I have no purpose, directly or indirectly, to interfere with the institution of slavery in the States where it exists. I believe I have no lawful right to do so, and I have no inclination [disposition] to do so.

— President Abraham Lincoln, First Inaugural Address, 1861

Why did President Lincoln **most** likely include this statement in this address?

- A.** to promote the expansion of slavery in Western states
- B.** to diffuse the ongoing Nullification Crisis in the South
- C.** to defend the provisions of the Kansas-Nebraska Act
- D.** to reassure Southern states considering secession

Which statement explains Stonewall Jackson's importance to the Confederacy during the Civil War?

- A.** his skill at political speaking
- B.** his ability to obtain foreign aid
- C.** his skill at economic organizing
- D.** his ability to lead troops into battle

The image depicts a significant historical event.

The Gallant Charge of the Fifty-Fourth Massachusetts Regiment

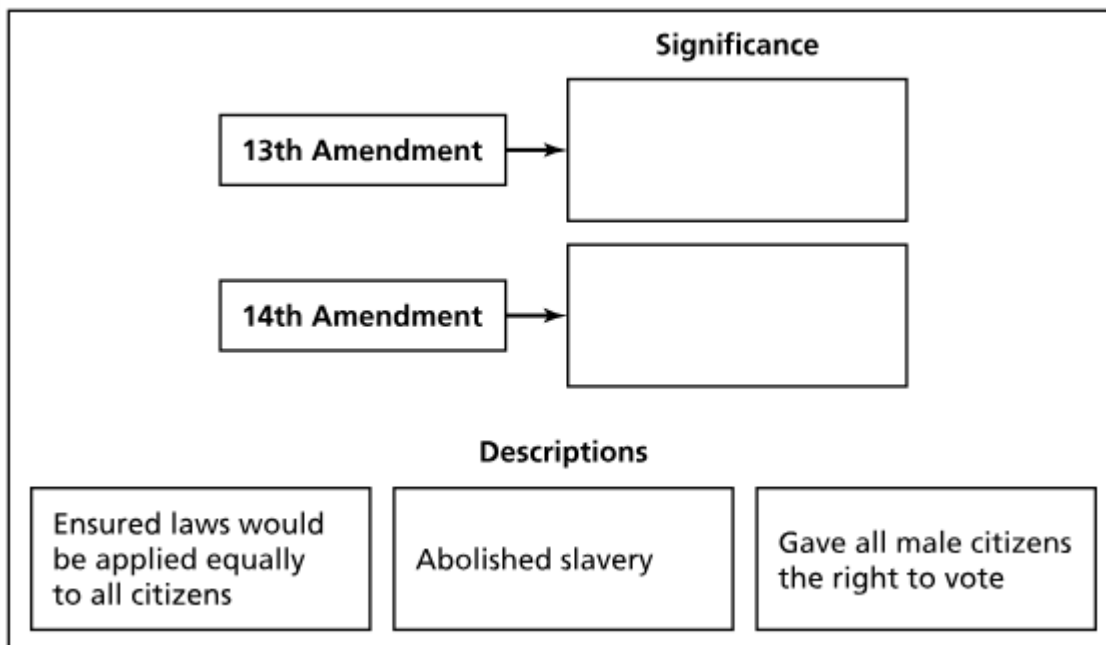


Source: Library of Congress

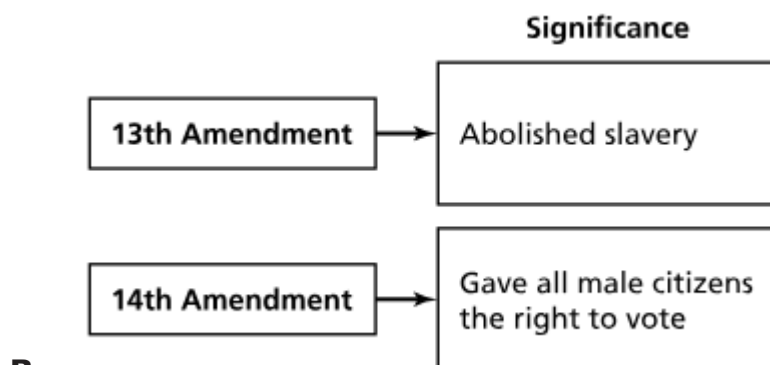
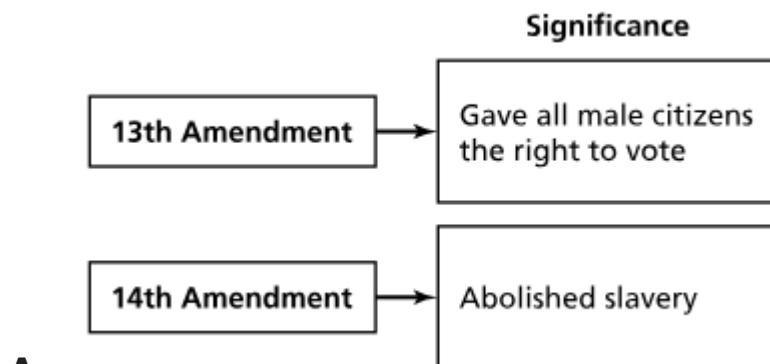
During the Battle of Fort Wagner, the regiment honored by this print

- A.** defeated the enemy with a surprise attack at night.
- B.** used new tactics that caused their opponents to surrender.
- C.** showed exceptional bravery by not retreating in the face of heavy casualties.
- D.** mounted an attack in order to carry wounded soldiers away from the fighting.

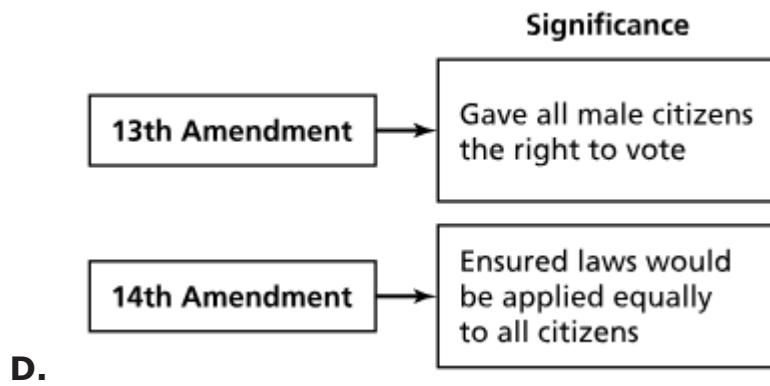
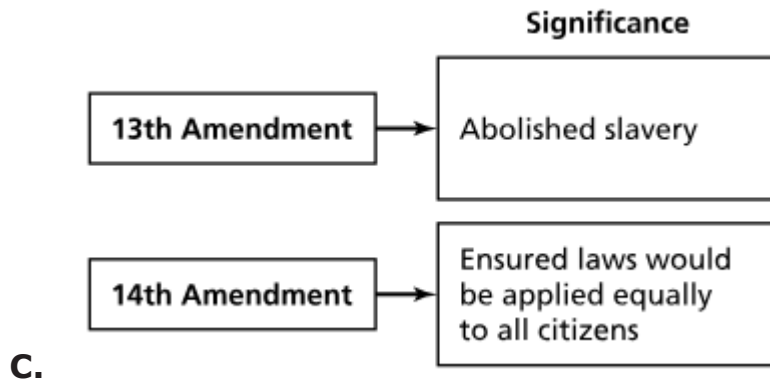
Use the descriptions to complete the diagram.



Which descriptions **best** complete this diagram about the Reconstruction Amendments?



(Continued on next page)



How was the Radical Republicans' Reconstruction plan for the South different from Abraham Lincoln's 10 Percent Plan?

- A.** Only the 10 Percent Plan supported the use of federal troops to restore order.
- B.** Only the Radical Republican Plan allowed former Confederate officials to vote.
- C.** The 10 Percent Plan had an easier path for states to participate in the federal government.
- D.** The Radical Republican Plan had a longer waiting period before allowing African Americans to vote.

How did the Tennessee Constitution of 1870 expand the rights of Tennessee's citizens?

- A.** It guaranteed the right of all men to vote.
- B.** It lowered the voting age to eighteen.
- C.** It extended voting rights to all women.
- D.** It banned the use of poll taxes in state elections.

What issue led to President Andrew Johnson's conflict with Radical Republicans?

- A.** violence committed by the Ku Klux Klan
- B.** construction of the Transcontinental Railroad
- C.** war with American Indians over claims to land
- D.** readmission of the southern states into the Union

The list describes effects of the Freedmen's Bureau.

Effects of the Freedmen's Bureau

- Reunited families that had been separated
- Helped freedmen obtain land
- _____?

Which phrase completes this list?

- A.** Created political platforms for Southern Democrats
- B.** Set primary goals of the Emancipation Proclamation
- C.** Oversaw educational opportunities of former slaves
- D.** Supported the readmission requirements of slave states

What name did southerners use for northern entrepreneurs who moved to the South during Reconstruction?

- A.** freedmen
- B.** scalawags
- C.** homesteaders
- D.** carpetbaggers

The paragraph below is about the presidential election of 1876.

The two candidates for president in 1876 were Republican Rutherford B. Hayes and Democrat Samuel Tilden. At the end of the electoral vote count, Democrat Samuel Tilden was one vote short of the 185 votes needed to win the presidency. However, there was a dispute involving the accuracy of the votes counted in three states. Congress created a commission to determine who had actually won the election. After the commission's investigation, Congress was left to decide the winner. Eventually, a compromise was reached and Rutherford B. Hayes became president.

Which action by the U.S. Congress persuaded Democrats to accept the election results?

- A.** passage of the Homestead Act
- B.** removal of federal troops from the South
- C.** construction of a railroad across the West
- D.** revision of federal policies for American Indians

Metadata- Social Studies Items

Page Number	Item Type	Key	TN Standards
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12	MC	B	8.35
13	MC	A	8.37
14	MC	A	8.39
15	MC	A	8.42
16	MC	C	8.45
17	MC	C	8.51
18	MC	B	8.52
19	MC	B	8.55
20	MC	D	8.57
21	MC	D	8.62
22	MC	D	8.63
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28	MC	D	8.71
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30	MC	D	8.74
31	MC	B	8.75
Metadata Definitions			
Item Type	Indicates the type of item. MC= Multiple Choice; MS= Multiple Select		
Key	Correct answer.		
TN Standards	Primary educational standard assessed.		